joined their strength to his. The shogunate had begun as a lottery: he had convinced them to buy their way into it, and only then had been able to create the pool of power he would then share out. That he was able to do so, based only on his family name and what must have been astounding personal charm, changed Japan's political landscape forever.

Under Yoritomo, the samurai began to take hold of that promised political might. But the shogunate at Kamakura (also called the Kamakura *bakufu*, or "system of government") could not possibly control Japan. Minamoto Yoritomo did not command the sort of administrative network needed to run a country. Even his warriors were still banded together in traditional uneven clusters, owing loyalty to different lords and obligations to different clans; there was no accepted military structure, no clear lines of command. The Kamakura *bakufu* could not replace the ancient authority of the emperor in Kyoto; instead, the shogun would have to make use of it.[3]

Which meant keeping a cordial relationship with Kyoto.

Yoritomo knew this. His negotiations with the pragmatic Cloistered Emperor Go-Shirakawa, right after the victory of 1185, had gotten him official, imperial recognition of his Kamakura-based military government in the east. ("I have been unselfishly taking upon myself the concerns of the Emperor for the sake of the Imperial House," he reportedly told Go-Shirakawa. "With . . . military backing I was able to subdue the Emperor's enemies.") The shogunate would not take over the rule of Japan; instead, it would exist as one of two powerful cores around which Japan's political elite traveled, in an elliptical and unstable orbit. The emperor retained his ritual importance; the cloistered emperor, his administrative authority; and the shogun at Kamakura, the power to use force.[4]

Almost the first law issued by the new government at Kamakura was a regulation called *Goseibai shikimoku*: "No person, even one whose family have been hereditary vassals of the shogun for generations, shall be able to mobilize troops for military service without a current writ."[5] Sanctioned violence would remain the exclusive right of the shogunate for the next century and a half.

That right was a prize to be grasped, and when Yoritomo's twenty-year-old son Minamoto Yoriie became shogun in 1202, his grandfather grasped it. Hojo Tokimasa, father of Yoritomo's redoubtable widow, declared himself to be regent for his grandson. In 1203, Tokimasa set up a thirteen-man council to assume the power of the shogunate. He himself kept the ultimate power of the regency, naming himself *shikken* (Regent of the Shogun) and keeping Yoriie himself under close armed guard at a distant mountain temple near the coast. There Yoriie was said to have "entered the priesthood," which was a